

Several Western countries have called on Russia to revoke the independence of South Ossetia and Abkhazia.



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The statement was signed by representatives of Albania, Ireland, Norway, Estonia, France, the United Kingdom, and the United States. Russia's First Deputy Permanent Representative to the UN called his Western colleagues' statements "phantom pains" and, in turn, called on them to stop ignoring reality.

TSKHINVAL, August 4 – Sputnik . Several Western countries, including the United States, Great Britain, and France, issued a joint statement demanding that Russia withdraw its recognition of the independence of South Ossetia and Abkhazia.

The statement was **distributed** to the UN Security Council.

It was signed by six UN Security Council member countries: Estonia, France, Ireland, Norway, the United Kingdom, and the United States, along with Albania, which is soon to take a seat on the council. The group condemned Russia for its alleged "illegal military presence" in the republics.

"Today we once again call on the Russian Federation... to immediately withdraw its troops and security forces and to reconsider its recognition of the so-called independence of the Georgian territories of Abkhazia and the Tskhinvali region of South Ossetia," the statement said.

Dmitry Polyansky, Russia's First Deputy Permanent Representative to the UN, called the statements by his Western colleagues "phantom pains" and the independence of Abkhazia and South Ossetia "a reality that cannot be ignored," [RIA Novosti](#) reports .



Bibilov assessed the role of the agreement between South Ossetia and Russia on dual citizenship

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The diplomat called Russia's cooperation with South Ossetia and Abkhazia a stabilizing factor in the South Caucasus.

"And we don't see any role for the UN Security Council in this region," Polyansky said.

Russia, he said, advocates continuing consultations in Geneva between Georgia, South Ossetia, and Abkhazia to arrive at a "legal formula for their mutual obligations regarding the non-use of force and the resolution of other urgent issues."

"This should serve as a reliable guarantee against a repeat of Georgia's military adventures, which were directly or indirectly encouraged by some of our Western partners in 2008. The criminal actions committed by the regime of (former President Mikheil – ed.) Saakashvili, such as the bombing of sleeping Tskhinvali, must not be repeated," Polyansky said.

On the night of August 7-8, 2008, Georgian troops invaded South Ossetia, destroying much of the republic's capital and surrounding villages. The

fighting resulted in numerous casualties among civilians, as well as militias and Russian peacekeepers. Russia subsequently intervened in the conflict and launched an operation to coerce Georgia into peace.

On August 26 of that year, Moscow recognized the sovereignty of South Ossetia and Abkhazia. Russian leaders have repeatedly stated that the recognition of the republics' independence reflects existing realities and is not subject to revision.

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Media News2

What holiday is it in Russia and around the world today? May 17th.

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Read Sputnik's article to find out what significant events and dates are being celebrated around the world.

World Telecommunication and Information Society Day

World Telecommunication and Information Society Day is a professional holiday for all programmers, system administrators, Internet service providers, web designers, online editors, and all other people working in the field of information technology.

The purpose of this holiday is to promote awareness of the opportunities that the internet and information and communications technologies (ICT) can bring to societies and countries, as well as ways to bridge the digital divide. Information technology has significantly changed the face of civilization. It has caused a veritable explosion in the global economy, resulting in a dramatic increase in the quantity and quality of output. The significance of informatics, the field of human activity associated with the transformation of information using computers and other computing technology, is far broader. It offers humanity a previously unimaginable luxury: information and knowledge are becoming the primary treasures, opening up unprecedented opportunities for self-education.



A man in the office of a business incubator at the IT Park high-tech technopark in Kazan.

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Over the years, the festival has been held under various themes, including: "Promoting Global Cybersecurity," "Connecting Persons with Disabilities," "Protecting Children in Cyberspace," "Improving the Lives of Rural Communities through ICT," "Women and Girls in ICT," "ICT and Improving Road Safety," "Telecommunications and ICT: Driving Innovation," "ICT Entrepreneurship for Social Impact," "Ensuring Positive AI Outcomes for All," "Bridging the Standardization Gap," "Global Connectivity 2030: The

Role of ICT in Achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)," and others.

What happened on May 17

1215 - English barons seize London during a rebellion against King John Lackland.

1642 – Montreal was founded.

1656 - Russia declared war on Sweden.

1727 – Peter II, the young grandson of Peter I, ascended the Russian throne.

1792 – 24 brokers, sheltered from the sun under the shade of a spreading tree, founded the New York Stock Exchange. The site of this tree is today the site of Wall Street.

1916 - Daylight Saving Time was introduced in England for the first time.

1959 - Land distribution to peasants announced in Cuba.

1983 – A peace treaty was signed between Israel and Lebanon.

1983 — Valdai National Park was established in the RSFSR.



Valdai National Park. Ranger Grigory Kuznetsov during a tour of the park.

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2009 – The first test version of the computer game "Minecraft" was released, becoming one of the most popular in the world.

Which famous people were born on May 17?

1873 - Henri Barbusse (d. 1935), French writer ("Fire", "Light from the Abyss", "Stalin", "True Stories").
1946 - Galina Starovoitova (killed in 1998), Russian politician, leader of the Democratic Russia movement.
1950 – Valeria Novodvorskaya (d. 2014), Soviet and Russian politician, publicist, dissident.
1953 - Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, President of Kazakhstan since 2019.
1966 – Qusay Hussein (killed 2003), youngest son of Iraqi President Saddam Hussein.
1980 — Ksenia Novikova, Russian singer, lead singer of the group "Brilliant".

Orthodox calendar

Martyr Pelagia, Virgin of Tarsus

Saints Nikita (Nifont), Cyril, Nicephorus, Clement, Isaac, and the Alfanov (Sokolnitsky) brothers in Novgorod



What holiday is it in Russia and around the world today – May 16th?

May 15, 10:59 PM

Folk calendar: Pelageya the Intercessor, Day of the Idlers

On this day, the Orthodox Church honors the martyr Pelagia of Tarsus. Saint Pelagia (Pelageya) was always considered the protector of innocent maidens and all those unjustly wronged. She was also the patroness of birds. On the evening of St. Pelagia's Day, experienced gardeners performed a ritual to protect their crops from evil spirits and various pests. To do this, they would take a cracked pot out into the garden, place nettles pulled out by the roots in it, and place the pot upside down in the very center of the middle bed. It was believed that any enemy, touching the stinging nettles, would be frightened and flee the garden. Saint Pelagia's Day itself was also known as the Day of the Idlers. It was at this time that trees were felled to make spoons and other preserves called "Idlers."

Who celebrates their name day on May 17?

Ivan, Isaac, Cyril, Clement, Leonty, Maria, Nikita, Nikifor, Nikolai, Pelageya.